



WP Plugin Auditor v1.0.0 - open-source WordPress plugin that performs automated static security analysis on any installed plugin, directly from the WordPress admin

GIT - <https://github.com/ssmason/WP-Plugin-Auditor>

- Runs 29 security and code quality checks - from dangerous functions and SQL injection to unescaped output, hardcoded credentials, and nonce verification - reporting both findings and confirmed passes
- Zero friction workflow - one click from the Plugins page opens an inline modal with a live progress bar; reports are stored, retrievable, and exportable as JSON
- Built to WordPress.org submission standards - WPCS, PHPStan level 8, strict types, full AJAX security, capability checks, and multisite-aware uninstall
- Finds its own bugs - the plugin passes its own audit at CLEAN, validating the scanner against production-grade WordPress code

AUDITS

1. Dangerous functions (eval, exec, shell_exec, base64_decode, etc.)
2. Output escaping — unescaped echo, wrong escape function, _e() / __() without escaping
3. Input sanitization — unsanitized superglobals, missing wp_unslash()
4. Nonce verification — forms, AJAX handlers, GET actions
5. Capability checks — admin pages, write operations
6. Database queries — unprepared statements, raw mysql_* calls
7. Hardcoded credentials — passwords, API keys, tokens (value redacted in report)
8. Error suppression — error_reporting(0), ini_set on error settings
9. Obfuscated calls — variable variables, dynamic function names, preg_replace /e
10. Direct file access guard — missing defined('ABSPATH') || exit
11. Debug output PHP — var_dump, print_r, var_export
12. Debug output JS — console.log, console.warn, etc.
13. File permissions — world-writable files, PHP files with execute bit
14. Deprecated WordPress functions
15. Plugin structure — missing index.php sentinels, exposed readme files
16. Licensing — LICENSE file present, GPL-compatible license declared
17. PHP compatibility — PHP 8.0/8.1 features vs declared minimum version
18. Commented-out code — blocks of 5+ consecutive comment lines
19. Plugin header / metadata — missing required headers
20. External HTTP requests — all outbound calls reported as informational
21. Asset versioning — hardcoded version strings or false version argument
22. Redirect without exit — wp_redirect / wp_safe_redirect not followed by exit
23. Role name in current_user_can() — role names passed instead of capability names
24. Shortcode output escaping — unescaped return values in shortcode callbacks
25. Option writes without capability check — update_option, add_option, delete_option
26. Wrong \$wpdb->prepare() placeholder — %s for integers, %d for strings
27. Duplicate hook registrations — same hook/callback/priority registered more than once
28. Unnecessary closures — function() { return true; } instead of __return_true
29. Early translation calls — translation functions called at file scope before init



Plugin Audit report that Failed and clearly identifies issues

WordPress

Vanilla Hair and Beauty

2

0

New

2

Howdy, wp-admin

Media

Pages

Comments

Google Reviews

Services

Manifest

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Team

Appearance

Plugins1

Users

Tools

Available Tools

Import

Export

Site Health

Export Personal Data

Erase Personal Data

Plugin Auditor

Plugin Audit Reports

Bedrock: Search engine indexing has been discouraged because the current environment is development.

☐	Plugin	Risk	High	Medium	Low	Date	Actions
☐	Satori ACF Field Loop	CLEAN	8	0	2	2026-04-21 09:04	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Plugin Auditor	CLEAN	0	0	0	2026-04-21 09:03	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Plugin Auditor	MEDIUM	1	1	0	2026-04-21 08:52	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Satori Manifest	CRITICAL	25	0	11	2026-04-21 08:51	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Satori Manifest	CRITICAL	25	0	11	2026-04-21 08:47	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Satori Post Carousel	CRITICAL	10	13	0	2026-04-21 08:47	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Satori Post Carousel	CRITICAL	10	13	0	2026-04-21 08:44	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Satori Manifest	CRITICAL	25	0	11	2026-04-21 08:41	ViewDownload JSON
☐	Plugin Auditor	MEDIUM	1	0	0	2026-04-21 08:38	ViewDownload JSON

Plugin Audit reports can be deleted or kept for reference

WordPress

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2

0

New

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Howdy, wp-admin

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Export

WordPress 6.9.4 is available! [Please update now.](#)

Plugin Audit Reports

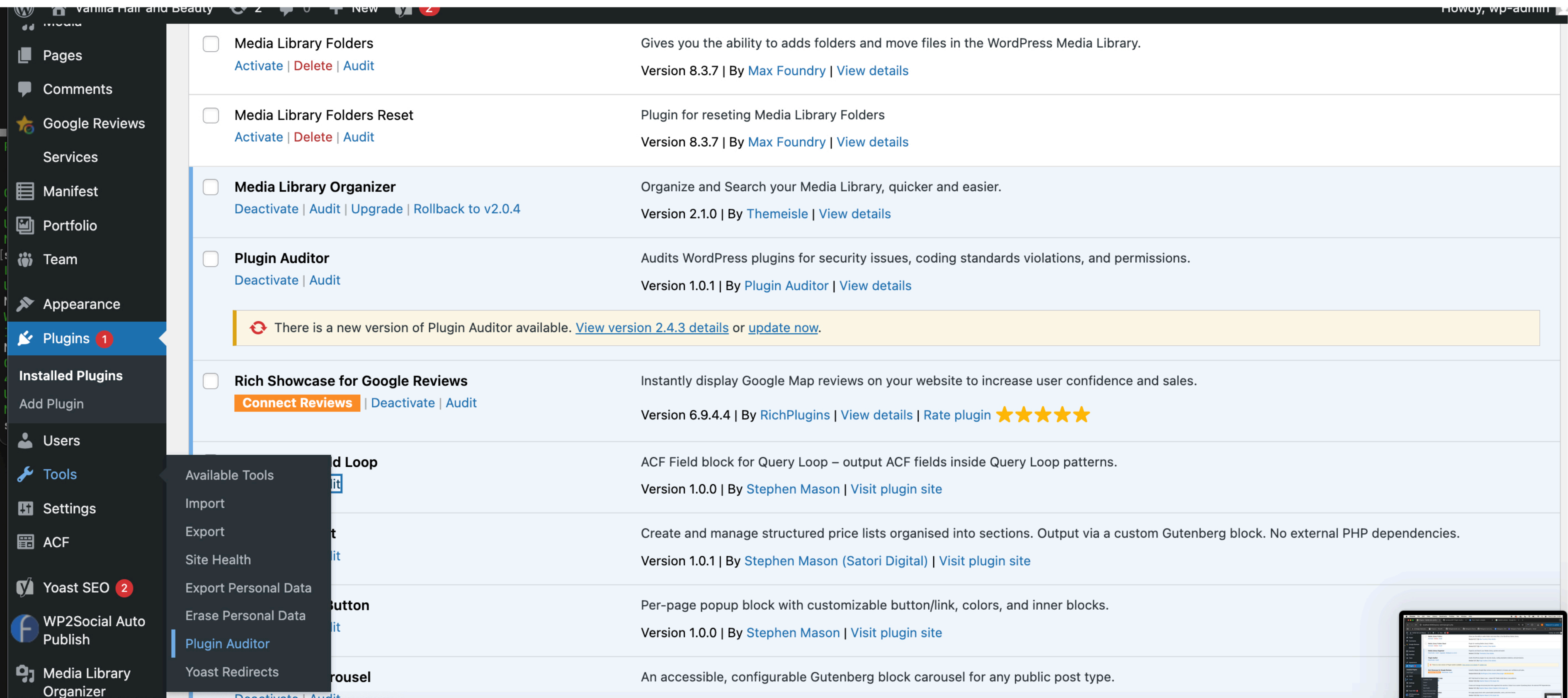
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☒	Plugin Auditor	MEDIUM	1	0	0	2026-04-21 08:35	ViewDownload JSON
☒	Media Library Folders Reset	CRITICAL	64	120	196	2026-04-20 19:18	ViewDownload JSON
☒	Media Library Folders Reset	CRITICAL	64	120	196	2026-04-20 19:16	ViewDownload JSON
☒	Media Library Folders Reset	CRITICAL	—	—	—	2026-04-20 17:52	ViewDownload JSON

Delete Selected

6 selected

Plugin page highlighting the “Audit” CTA & access to Tools



The screenshot shows the WordPress Admin Dashboard with the 'Plugins' menu item highlighted in the left sidebar. The 'Plugins' menu has a red notification badge with the number '1'. Below the sidebar, the 'Installed Plugins' section is visible, showing a list of installed plugins. The 'Plugin Auditor' plugin is highlighted in blue. A yellow notification banner is displayed above the 'Plugin Auditor' plugin entry, stating: 'There is a new version of Plugin Auditor available. [View version 2.4.3 details](#) or [update now](#).' The 'Plugin Auditor' entry shows the 'Audit' button in blue. The 'Tools' menu item in the sidebar is also visible, with a red notification badge with the number '2'.

Plugin Name	Description	Version	Author	Buttons
Media Library Folders	Gives you the ability to adds folders and move files in the WordPress Media Library.	Version 8.3.7	By Max Foundry View details	Activate Delete Audit
Media Library Folders Reset	Plugin for resetting Media Library Folders	Version 8.3.7	By Max Foundry View details	Activate Delete Audit
Media Library Organizer	Organize and Search your Media Library, quicker and easier.	Version 2.1.0	By Themeisle View details	Deactivate Audit Upgrade Rollback to v2.0.4
Plugin Auditor	Audits WordPress plugins for security issues, coding standards violations, and permissions.	Version 1.0.1	By Plugin Auditor View details	Deactivate Audit
There is a new version of Plugin Auditor available. View version 2.4.3 details or update now .				
Rich Showcase for Google Reviews	Instantly display Google Map reviews on your website to increase user confidence and sales.	Version 6.9.4.4	By RichPlugins View details Rate plugin ★★★★★	Connect Reviews Deactivate Audit
ACF Field block for Query Loop	ACF Field block for Query Loop – output ACF fields inside Query Loop patterns.	Version 1.0.0	By Stephen Mason Visit plugin site	Audit
Structured Price Lists	Create and manage structured price lists organised into sections. Output via a custom Gutenberg block. No external PHP dependencies.	Version 1.0.1	By Stephen Mason (Satori Digital) Visit plugin site	Audit
Per-page popup block	Per-page popup block with customizable button/link, colors, and inner blocks.	Version 1.0.0	By Stephen Mason Visit plugin site	Audit
Accessible Gutenberg block carousel	An accessible, configurable Gutenberg block carousel for any public post type.			Deactivate Audit



Plugin Audit report that has passed as clean and suitable for production

Beauty

2

0

New

2

Plugin Audit

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Plugin Auditor

Audited: 2026-04-21 09:03

Risk: **CLEAN** (Score: 0)

No significant issues found. This plugin passed all security and code quality checks — no action required.

Severity	Count	Guidance
Critical	0	Fix immediately
High	0	Address urgently
Medium	0	Address when possible
Low	0	Review and consider
Info	6	Informational only

Dangerous Functions **PASS**

Output Escaping **PASS**

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External HTTP Requests **PASS**

File Permissions **PASS**

Plugin Header / Metadata

Severity	File	Line	Message	Snippet
LOW	satori-acf-field-loop.php		Missing "Requires PHP" header.	
LOW	satori-acf-field-loop.php		Missing "Requires at least" header.	

Asset Versioning **PASS**

Error Suppression **PASS**

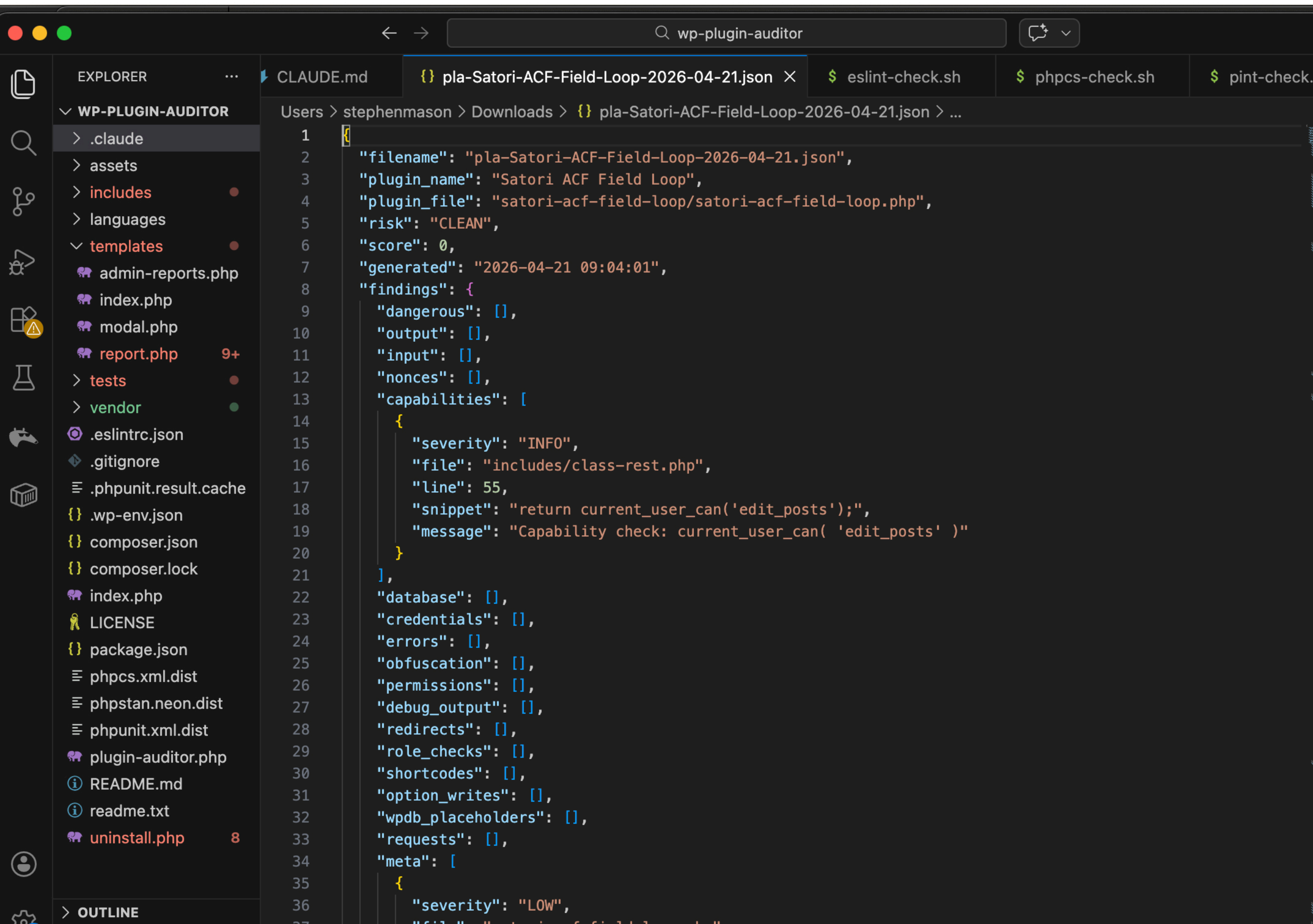
Obfuscated Calls **PASS**

Direct File Access Guard

Severity	File	Line	Message	Snippet
HIGH	satori-acf-field-loop.php		Missing direct file access guard add defined('ABSPATH') exit; at the top of the file.	
HIGH	includes/class-assets.php		Missing direct file access guard add defined('ABSPATH') exit; at the top of the file.	

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Plugin Audit report can be downloaded in json format



The screenshot shows a VS Code editor window with the following elements:

- Explorer Panel:** Displays the file structure of the 'WP-PLUGIN-AUDITOR' project. Files include `.claude`, `assets`, `includes`, `languages`, `templates` (containing `admin-reports.php`, `index.php`, `modal.php`, `report.php` with 9+ errors), `tests`, `vendor`, `.eslintrc.json`, `.gitignore`, `.phpunit.result.cache`, `.wp-env.json`, `composer.json`, `composer.lock`, `index.php`, `LICENSE`, `package.json`, `phpcs.xml.dist`, `phpstan.neon.dist`, `phpunit.xml.dist`, `plugin-auditor.php`, `README.md`, `readme.txt`, and `uninstall.php` with 8 errors.
- Editor Panel:** Shows the JSON file `pla-Satori-ACF-Field-Loop-2026-04-21.json`. The content is a JSON object representing an audit report.
- Terminal Panel:** Shows the command `wp-plugin-auditor` in the search bar and several shell commands: `eslint-check.sh`, `phpcs-check.sh`, and `pint-check.sh`.

```
{
  "filename": "pla-Satori-ACF-Field-Loop-2026-04-21.json",
  "plugin_name": "Satori ACF Field Loop",
  "plugin_file": "satori-acf-field-loop/satori-acf-field-loop.php",
  "risk": "CLEAN",
  "score": 0,
  "generated": "2026-04-21 09:04:01",
  "findings": {
    "dangerous": [],
    "output": [],
    "input": [],
    "nonces": [],
    "capabilities": [
      {
        "severity": "INFO",
        "file": "includes/class-rest.php",
        "line": 55,
        "snippet": "return current_user_can('edit_posts');",
        "message": "Capability check: current_user_can( 'edit_posts' )"
      }
    ]
  },
  "database": [],
  "credentials": [],
  "errors": [],
  "obfuscation": [],
  "permissions": [],
  "debug_output": [],
  "redirects": [],
  "role_checks": [],
  "shortcodes": [],
  "option_writes": [],
  "wpdb_placeholders": [],
  "requests": [],
  "meta": [
    {
      "severity": "LOW",
      "file": "includes/class-rest.php",
      "line": 55,
      "snippet": "return current_user_can('edit_posts');",
      "message": "Capability check: current_user_can( 'edit_posts' )"
    }
  ]
}
```



Plugin Audit report that Failed and clearly identifies issues

Plugin Audit

Satori Manifest

Audited: 2026-04-21 08:51

Risk: CRITICAL (Score: 125)

This plugin has 1 critical and 25 high severity issue(s) that require immediate action. With a risk score of 125, this plugin should not be used in production until the critical and high findings below have been resolved.

Severity	Count	Guidance
Critical	1	Fix immediately
High	25	Address urgently
Medium	0	Address when possible
Low	11	Review and consider
Info	6	Informational only

Plugin Audit

Input Sanitization

Severity	File	Line	Message	Snippet
HIGH	includes/class-meta-box.php	175	Unsanitized input: \$_POST accessed without sanitization.	? wp_unslash((string) \$_POST[self::POST_FIE LD])

Nonce Verification

Severity	File	Line	Message	Snippet
CRITICAL	includes/class-meta-box.php		File handles \$_POST data but has no wp_verify_nonce() or check_admin_referer() call.	

Capability Checks

Severity	File	Line	Message	Snippet
HIGH	includes/class-multisite.php	135	Write operation without a visible current_user_can() check in the preceding scope.	delete_option('satori_manifest_version');
HIGH	includes/class-multisite.php	136	Write operation without a visible current_user_can() check in the preceding scope.	delete_option('satori_manifest_patterns_se eded');
HIGH	includes/class-patterns.php	138	Write operation without a visible current_user_can() check in the preceding scope.	update_option('satori_manifest_patterns_se eded', SATORI_MANIFEST_VERSION, false);
HIGH	includes/class-plugin.php	113	Write operation without a visible current_user_can() check in the preceding scope.	update_option('satori_manifest_version', S ATORI_MANIFEST_VERSION);

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